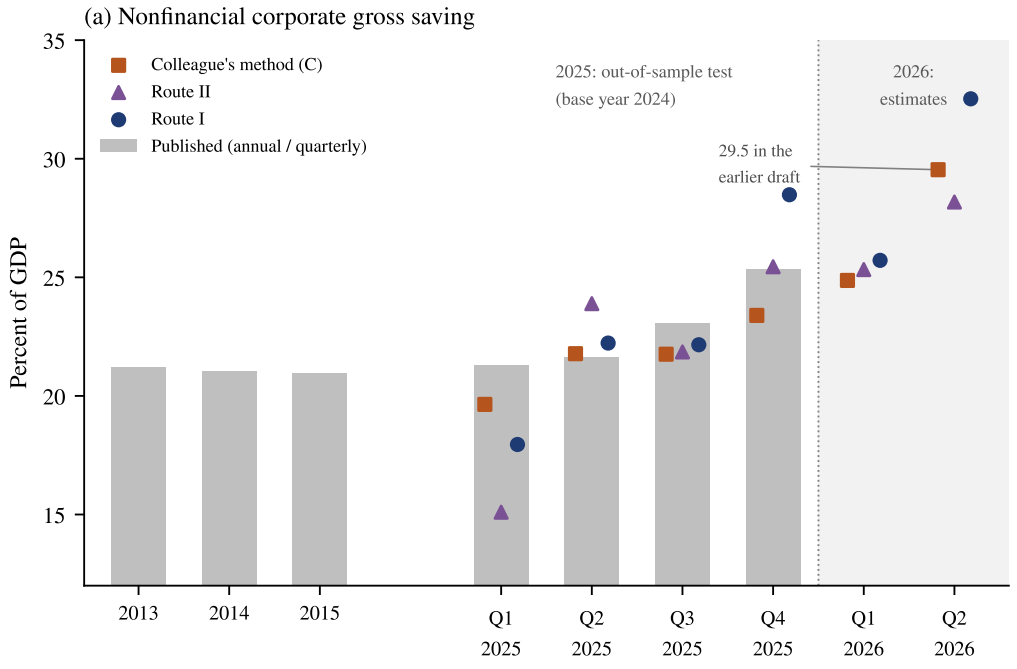
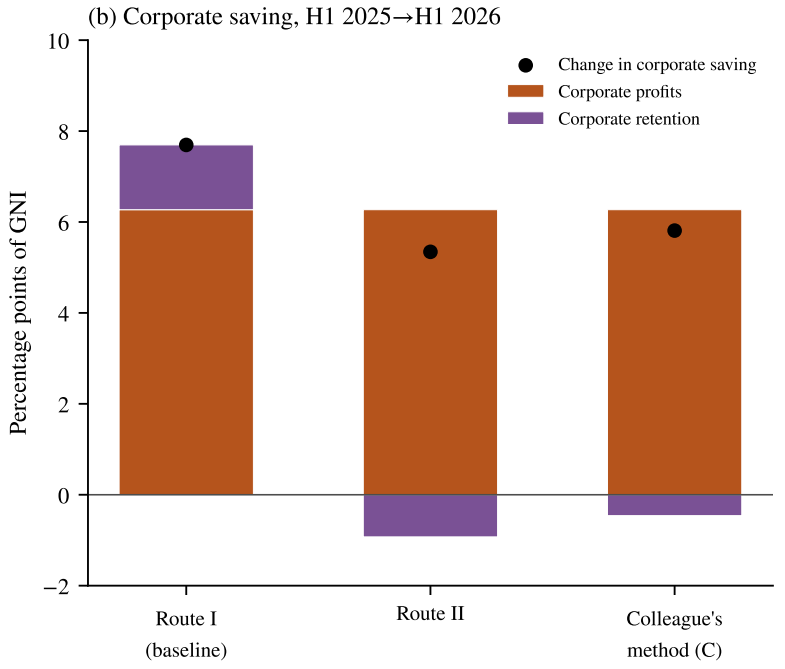
Three ways to estimate corporate saving agree that profits drove the 2026 rise





Notes: (a) Grey bars: published gross saving of nonfinancial corporations (annual 2013–15; quarterly 2025). Markers: estimates. Method C (the earlier draft's footnote): investment = total gross capital formation less government fixed capital formation, scaled to the base year's corporate investment; saving = that investment + flow-of-funds net lending + the base year's capital-account adjustments and discrepancy as a share of GDP. Route I: national saving less published household saving, government saving (flow-of-funds net lending + investment + gap at the base share) and financial-corporation saving (base share). Route II: as C, but with base values from the same quarter a year earlier. 2025 quarters use 2024 as the base, so they test each method out of sample. (b) Profit component = change in operating surplus (implied growth 58%) at the H1 2025 retention ratio, the same for all three; retention = the rest. Source: Bank of Korea; authors' calculations.